DIGITAL LITERACY VITYARTHI PROJECT

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INTRODUCTION

This project was designed as a comprehensive deep dive into digital literacy and professional technical branding. As a first-year CSE student at VIT Bhopal, navigating the transition from a casual internet user to a professional developer is a critical milestone. The scenario focused on establishing a secure, professional, and high-impact digital presence while mastering the basics of cybersecurity and collaborative tools. Throughout this project, I explored how to build a technical portfolio, secure my financial digital identity (UPI safety), and communicate effectively within a technical ecosystem. By integrating academic learning with real world digital hygiene, this project serves as a foundational blueprint for my journey toward becoming a competitive programmer and an AI professional.

Task 1:

Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic To kick off my role as a Student Digital Ambassador, I designed a visual infographic aimed at simplifying the core pillars of digital literacy for my peers. I chose Canva as my primary design tool because its extensive library of templates allowed me to maintain a clean, professional aesthetic while focusing on high-impact information delivery. My design specifically highlights three critical areas: essential digital tools for academic success, safe internet practices to protect personal data, and the nuances of professional email etiquette.

The most interesting part of this process was finding the right balance between technical detail and visual clarity. I realized that for an infographic to be effective for busy students, it must be "scannable." One challenge I encountered was condensing complex topics, like cybersecurity, into actionable bullet points without losing their importance. This exercise taught me that being digitally literate isn't just about using tools, but also about communicating those concepts effectively to others. I hope this resource serves as a practical starting point for our batch as we navigate our four year engineering journey.

CANVA LINK: https://canva.link/gf4vbh37svmkrzo

Task 2:

Student Digital Portfolio For the second module, I focused on establishing a professional digital presence across three primary platforms: **GitHub**, **LinkedIn**, and **Kaggle**. I chose these specific platforms because they represent the essential pillars of a modern engineering career—technical version control, professional networking, and data science exploration. On GitHub, I initialized my profile README to showcase my current academic standing in Computer Science and Engineering and my commitment to mastering foundational programming concepts. On LinkedIn, I updated my educational background to reflect my enrolment at **VIT Bhopal University** with an expected graduation in 2029.

These platforms will serve as a living record of my growth over the next four years. I plan to use GitHub as a central repository for my academic projects and competitive programming progress, while LinkedIn will help me connect with industry professionals and track internship opportunities. Kaggle will be my gateway into practical machine learning and AI challenges. Setting these up early ensures that by the time I reach my final year, I will have a robust, verifiable portfolio that demonstrates my technical evolution and professional consistency to potential employers.

Task 3:

Platforms and Collaboration For this module, I demonstrated technical proficiency and collaborative data collection by engaging with **HackerRank** and **Google Forms**. As a Computer Science student, I utilized HackerRank to solve foundational logic problems, which allowed me to practice translating algorithmic thinking into clean code. This platform is essential for my growth in competitive programming, as it provides a standardized environment to verify my solutions.

Additionally, I designed a five-question "Digital Literacy Quiz" using Google Forms to simulate a real-world data collection scenario. I focused on including a variety of question types, such as multiple-choice and short-answer, to ensure comprehensive data gathering. The most interesting aspect of this task was observing how digital tools can automate the transition from raw data in a form to organized information in a linked spreadsheet. One challenge was ensuring the questions were clear enough to avoid ambiguous responses. This task highlighted the importance of using structured platforms to facilitate seamless collaboration and data management in an academic or professional setting.

Google Form :
https://docs.google.com/forms/d/e/1FAIpQLSeaRp4iyYMeWZSyWS3nnTg9OH3SsOIZtOqM2XJyXoORjfqRCw/viewform?usp=publish-editor

Task 4:

Professional Communication Effective communication is a cornerstone of professional success, and this task allowed me to refine my skills in formal digital correspondence and social media etiquette. I drafted two distinct emails: one requesting a deadline extension from a faculty member and another expressing interest in a technical internship. These exercises taught me the importance of a clear subject line, a respectful salutation, and a concise "call to action." I learned that professional emails must balance being direct with being polite to ensure the recipient can provide a helpful response.

Furthermore, I compiled a "Do's and Don'ts" checklist for student social media use. I realized that as a Student Digital Ambassador, my online presence acts as a digital resume. One interesting discovery during this task was how easily a casual tone can be misinterpreted in a professional context. The primary difficulty was maintaining a tone that was professional yet authentic to my status as a first-year student. This module reinforced that every digital interaction contributes to my long-term professional brand, necessitating a mindful approach to all online communication.

Task 5:

Cybercrime and Digital Safety The final module addressed the critical issue of cybersecurity, specifically focusing on the rise of **UPI and Online Payment Fraud**. I conducted a case study on phishing attacks, where I analyzed how deceptive tactics are used to compromise financial security. Understanding the mechanics of these crimes is vital in an increasingly cashless economy. I documented how attackers exploit psychological triggers—like urgency or fear—to lead victims to fraudulent links.

To provide practical value to my peers, I developed an eight-tip "Stay Safe Online" checklist. This includes essential practices such as enabling two-factor authentication and verifying UPI IDs before confirming transactions. The most challenging part of this task was staying updated on the latest fraud techniques, as cyber threats evolve rapidly. It was particularly interesting to learn about the **National Cyber Crime Helpline (1930)** and how immediate reporting can mitigate damage. This task has made me more vigilant about my digital footprint and has equipped me with the knowledge to educate others in our batch about maintaining a secure digital environment.

CONCLUSION

Completing this project has been a real eye-opener for me as I start my journey in Computer Science. It's easy to think that being a "tech student" just means knowing how to write C++ code or solve DSA problems, but this project taught me that **technical skill is only half the story**. The other half is how you carry yourself in the digital world.

The most important things I've taken away from these tasks are:

- **Communication is Key**: Whether I was completing the "Solve Me First" challenge or drafting a professional email, I realized that everything we create is a form of communication. Writing clean code and clear documentation isn't just a requirement; it's a way to respect the people you're collaborating with, whether in a hackathon or a future job.
- **Security is a Daily Habit**: Investigating identity theft and UPI fraud really changed my perspective. I used to think a strong password was enough, but I now understand that my digital identity—especially in a hostel environment— is something I have to actively protect every single day. Security isn't a "setting" you turn on; it's a mindset you maintain.
- **Building a Story, Not Just a Resume**: Setting up my GitHub and LinkedIn wasn't just about ticking off a box for an assignment. It was about starting a digital diary of my progress from 2025 to 2029. It taught me how to showcase projects like MediCube and my work with the Insight Club so that my growth is visible to mentors and future employers.

Ultimately, this project has given me a "Digital Toolkit" that I'll be using for the rest of my four years here. I feel much more confident now—not just in my ability to code, but in my ability to navigate the professional world with a secure, intentional, and sharp digital presence.

REFRENCES:

Canva.com

github.com

linkedin.com

hackerrank.com

forms.google.com

cybercrime.gov.in

Cyber Crime Helpline1930 (24x7 phone)